

Maze

G6 / Benchmark Assessment

Directions: Make sure you have reviewed the scoring rules in the *Acadience Reading K–6 Assessment Manual* and have them available. Say these specific directions to the students:

1. Before handing out the worksheets, say ***I am going to give you a worksheet. When you get your worksheet, please write your name at the top and put your pencil down.*** Hand out the Maze student worksheets. Make sure each student has the appropriate worksheet.

When all of the students are ready, say ***You are going to read a story with some missing words. For each missing word there will be a box with three words. Circle the word that makes the most sense in the story. Look at Practice 1.***

Listen. After playing in the dirt, Sam went (pause) home, summer, was (pause) to wash her hands. You should circle the word “home” because “home” makes the most sense in the story. Listen. After playing in the dirt, Sam went home to wash her hands.

Now it is your turn. Read Practice 2 silently. When you come to a box, read all the words in the box and circle the word that makes the most sense in the story. When you are done, put your pencil down.

Allow up to 30 seconds for students to complete the example and put their pencils down. If necessary, after 30 seconds say ***Put your pencil down.***

2. As soon as all students have their pencils down, say ***Listen. On her way home, she (pause) chair, sleep, saw (pause) an ice cream truck. You should have circled “saw” because “saw” makes the most sense in the story. Listen. On her way home, she saw an ice cream truck.***

When I say “begin,” turn the page over and start reading the story silently. When you come to a box, read all the words in the box and circle the word that makes the most sense in the story. Ready? Begin. Start your stopwatch after you say “begin.”

3. Monitor students to ensure they are reading and circling the words. Use the reminders as needed.
4. At the end of **3 minutes**, stop your stopwatch and say ***Stop. Put your pencil down.*** Collect all of the Maze worksheet packets.

Timing	3 minutes. Start your stopwatch after you say “begin.”
Reminders	If the student starts reading the passage out loud, say <i>Remember to read the story silently.</i> (Repeat as often as needed.) If the student is not working on the task, say <i>Remember to circle the word in each box that makes the most sense in the story.</i> (Repeat as often as needed.) If the student asks you to provide a word for them or, in general, for help with the task, say <i>Just do your best.</i> (Repeat as often as needed.)

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Alicia and the Science Fair

The bell rang, and everyone in the classroom began to gather books, zip up backpacks, and don

jackets. As Alicia slung her backpack over her **shoulder**, her teacher, Mr. Odin, called out,

“**Okay**, everybody, the science fair is next **month**, so start thinking of a project

this **weekend**!”

Alicia joined her friend Tomiko, and the **two** made their way to the bus and **sat**

down. Alicia asked, “Tomiko, how exactly **does** the science fair work? My old **school** didn't have

them.”

Tomiko looked excited, and **eagerly** responded, “I know you'll really love the **science** fair,

Alicia! Everyone creates a project, and after we **set** them up in the cafeteria, the **science**

teachers decide which projects will be **awarded** prizes. The competition isn't really as **important** as

researching and creating the projects, **though**. I've never won a ribbon, but I **always** enjoy coming

up with a project and **creating** my presentation. I had a lot of **fun** last year, when I examined

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what	factors	were involved in giving a marble	enough	energy to go around a loop in a	curved	21
pipe.”						21
Alicia was puzzled, and asked her, “	Wait	, playing with marbles can be a	project	? I always		23
figured you had to	create	a new invention or something like that.”				24
Tomiko	shook	her head and said, “No, that’s	what’s	interesting about it. You can use		26
science		and the scientific method to answer	almost	any question you have about the		28
world		, and investigate things you’ve wondered about or	want	to understand better. The science		30
fair	gives	you an opportunity to conduct an	investigation	and find out some answers.”		32
Alicia	said	, “By the scientific method, you mean like	question	, hypothesis, and so forth?”		34
“Exactly,” said Tomiko. “For my	project	, I made a track out of	pipe	that started up		36
high, zoomed down to the	ground	, and then went back up in a	loop	. My question was what it would		38
take		for the marble to go around the	loop	. I started by researching kinetic energy and	vertical	41

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energy. Based on my first readings, I **made** a hypothesis that the marble would **complete** the loop if 43

its initial position **was** at the same height as the **top** of the loop. ” 45

“Did it work?” **asked** Alicia. 46

Tomiko said, “No, so I **tried** to discover why and researched some **more** about slope and 48

friction. I kept **refining** my hypothesis and running different experiments, **then** expanding my 50

experiments to look at **different** variables. I changed the height and **length** of the initial drop and 52

the **size** of the loop. I tried pipes that **were** of different materials and sizes and **marbles** of 55

different weights. I got really **interested** in the whole project, and at the **end** I had learned a lot.” 57

“Wow, that **sounds** really cool,” said Alicia. “I didn’t **realize** you could investigate something 59

like that. **Maybe** I could do a project on a **fun** topic, like the beets I’ve been **growing**.” 62

“That’s a great idea,” exclaimed Tomiko. “**Actually**, I was thinking about doing a **project** 64

on plant biology. Do you want to **work** together on this project?” 65

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“Sure!” said Alicia. “I **can't** wait to see what we'll discover **working** on our project for the

science **fair**.”